FOUNDER'S CODE 2026

Hackathon FAQs | Simple answers for every participant

1 TEAMS & PASSES

1. What types of teams can join?

Tech Only, Business Only, and Tech + Business teams.

2. I have a Tech Pass. Must I know business?

No. Focus on building the product. The Hackathon Organizing Team will arrange grouping or merging with business participants where needed.

3. I have a Business Pass. Must I know coding?

No. Focus on the customer problem, market, revenue idea, and how to reach users. The organizing team will arrange grouping with tech participants where needed.

4. Who will merge the teams?

The Hackathon Organizing Team. You do not need to find a partner team yourself.

5. What if there are not enough Business Only teams?

An existing Tech team member may represent the business side. The organizing team will confirm the final grouping.

6. We have four Tech members. Must we add a fifth?

Not necessarily. If one member can take the business role, an extra member may not be needed. Any addition must follow the final team-size rules.

7. Why is the Tech + Business Pass Rs. 200 more?

The organizers will confirm the exact extra benefits and eligibility rules. Do not assume that taking a business role changes your paid pass.

2 TOPICS & SUBMISSIONS

8. Will we receive a fixed problem statement?

You will receive approved domains and example ideas. Your team must choose a specific real-life problem to solve.

9. How many ideas must we submit?

Submit 3 topic ideas. They may all be from one domain or from different domains.

10. What goes into each topic proposal?

One page: topic title, domain, problem, solution, technical plan, business plan, expected impact, and risks.

11. What if our topic is not approved?

Jury approval is compulsory. A team cannot continue with an unapproved problem statement; follow the organizers' instructions on any permitted revision.

3 JUDGING & DEVELOPMENT

12. How will Tech Only participants be judged?

Mainly on their technical work: working features, quality of code, design, and how well they explain their solution.

13. How will Business Only participants be judged?

Mainly on customer understanding, market research, business model, how they will reach users, and their pitch.

14. How will combined teams be judged?

On both the product and the business plan. The final presentation should explain what was built and why people would use it.

15. What work gets the most importance?

Work actually completed during the hackathon gets the highest importance. Keep clear proof of your progress.

16. Can we use old code, AI, or open-source tools?

Yes. Clearly show what existed before the event and what you built during it. Using ready-made tools alone will not earn the same credit as original work.

17. Do we need GitHub?

Yes. Keep your code organized, use clear commit messages, and show your development history.

18. Does security or accessibility matter?

Yes. The jury also values safe, private, affordable, and accessible solutions. Technical scoring is planned as 80% core work and 20% jury assessment of meaningful quality improvements.

19. Are Tech Only teams eligible for the overall prize?

The organizers will confirm the final championship eligibility and common judging rules. Different tracks have different areas of focus.

4 ON THE EVENT DAY

20. What should we bring?

Your laptop, charger, extension cord, and access to your proposal, slides, and GitHub account.

21. Can the jury give surprise tasks?

Yes. Be ready to explain your work and respond to additional challenges announced during the event.

Remember: Build something useful, show what you made during the event, and explain both the technology and the business idea.